



Scandinavians: Greenland is a largely self-governing territory owned by Denmark. Since almost all the land is permanently covered with thick ice, only about 57,000 people live there, mainly scattered along the

southernwestern fringe. Greenland has two official languages: Danish and Greenlandic, an Inuit dialect peppered with Danish words. Many locals, however, feel strongly that only Greenlandic should be recognized.

COMMUNITY LIFE

Greenlanders live mainly in urban centers like the pretty harbor town of Ilulissat. Within each town or city, there are conventional roads, but these do not usually link one center with another—people travel long distances by air. Housing is modern and well insulated, and shopping is done in ordinary supermarkets. Most produce is imported, though, and meat from seabirds, seals, and whales is sold alongside beef and lamb.

FISHY PROFITS

Greenland's fishing industry produces 95 percent of its commercial revenue. There are more than 200 species of fish and seafood in the island's waters, but the principal trade is in cold-water prawns and halibut.

Fishermen sell most of their produce through wholesale companies like this one, where halibut is being packed for shipment.



HISTORIC CRAFT

Greenland attracts large numbers of tourists, many of whom take home traditional *tupilak* figures carved by the Inuit from soapstone, caribou antler, or whale tooth. Typical examples like these represent mythical creatures from Inuit legend.



COLORFUL CLOTHING

Greenlandic dress is one of the few national costumes that involve pants for women.

Featuring intricate motifs, beading, and sometimes even lace, the outfit always includes high boots: white ones for young unmarried girls; red for those who are married; and blue or yellow for older women.

